

HOMEHELP PH: A Technology-Based Support and Referral Platform for Homeless
Children and Families

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INTRODUCTION

Homelessness of children and families is a serious social issue in the Philippines. Street children face an increased risk of poverty, disrupted education, inadequate housing, abuse, and exploitation. According to the Department of Social Welfare and Development (DSWD), children and families living or staying regularly on the streets are vulnerable groups that need community-based social services, including access to housing, social assistance, education, and other services. Yet, for homeless children and their families, getting an accurate picture of the help they need is complicated and the process of requesting aid can be challenging. The proposed project will implement a technological innovation that will make the information and services requested accessible.

PROPOSED SOLUTION

HOMEHELP PH is a proposed mobile and web application that connects homeless individuals, families, and vulnerable children to existing organizations and agencies that can help them. It could offer features such as the location of nearby shelters and social service centers, food, health, education, financial assistance, and a link to an online referral system to connect to these agencies, including DSWD and local social welfare offices. It could also have an emergency contact feature, and a service or donation section for organizations offering their services or donating to the cause. It could be integrated with the services offered by DSWD's existing Pag-abot Program, which aims to provide outreach, access to referrals, shelter, and other services to street

dwellers.

CONCLUSION

HOMEHELP PH may provide a solution for better accessibility to the existing support services for the homeless children and their families. It can offer appropriate information to the ones in need of assistance and help them connect with the shelters, social workers, health services, education, and other available resources. The problem of homelessness cannot be solved using technology but by providing the means for communication with the relevant authorities and services can help establish safer and better living conditions for the homeless.

REFERENCES:

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